

Meaning of Staffing

- In simplest terms, staffing is "putting people to jobs."
- It begins with workforce planning and includes functions like recruitment, selection, training, development, compensation, and performance appraisal.
- Staffing is the process of management concerned with obtaining, utilizing, and maintaining a satisfactory and satisfied workforce.

Importance of Staffing

- Proper staffing ensures:
- Competent Personnel: Helps in discovering and obtaining competent personnel for various jobs.
 - Higher Performance: Achieved by placing the right person on the right job.
 - Continuous Survival & Growth: Ensures through succession planning for managers.
 - Optimum Human Resource Utilization: Avoids overmanning.
 - Improved Job Satisfaction: Enhances employee morale through objective assessment and fair reward.

Staffing as part of Human Resource Management

- Deals with the human element of management.
- The success of an organization depends on the competence, motivation, and performance of its human resources.
- Key functions of HR Management:
 - Recruitment and selection of qualified people.
 - Job analysis and description.
 - Developing compensation and incentive plans.
 - Training and development for efficient performance and career growth.
 - Maintaining labor relations and union management relations.
 - Handling grievances and complaints.
 - Providing for social security and welfare.
 - Defending the company in lawsuits and avoiding legal complications.

Staffing Process

1. Estimating Manpower Requirements
 - Workload Analysis: Assesses the number and types of human resources needed.
 - Workforce Analysis: Reveals the number and type of human resources available.
 - Determines if the organization is understaffed, overstaffed, or optimally staffed.
2. Recruitment
 - Definition: Process of searching for prospective employees and stimulating them to apply for jobs.
 - Information from job descriptions and candidate profiles is used for "situations vacant" advertisements.
 - Advertisements can be displayed on factory/office gates, print media, or electronic media.
3. Selection
 - Process of choosing from the pool of prospective job candidates.
 - Even if there are few applicants, screening is required.
4. Placement and Orientation
 - Placement: Joining a job marks the beginning of an employee's socialization.
 - Orientation: Introducing the selected employee to colleagues, superiors, and subordinates, and familiarizing them with company rules and policies.
5. Training and Development
 - Provides opportunities for employees to grow and advance their careers.
 - Organizations facilitate learning through in-house training centers or alliances with educational institutes.
6. Performance Appraisal
 - Definition: Evaluating an employee's current and/or past performance against predetermined standards.
 - Superiors provide feedback on performance.
7. Promotion and Career Planning
 - Organizations address career-related issues and promotional avenues for employees.
 - Promotions: Filling higher jobs by promoting employees from lower positions, leading to higher responsibilities, status, and pay. It is a vertical shifting of employees.
 - Managers design activities to serve employees' long-term interests, encouraging growth and potential realization.
8. Compensation
 - Establishing wage and salary plans based on job worth.
 - Forms of Compensation:
 - Direct Financial Payments: Wages, salaries, incentives, commissions, bonuses.
 - Indirect Payments: Employer-paid insurance, vacations.

Recruitment

- Definition: The process of finding possible candidates for a job or a function. It is "the process of searching for prospective employees and stimulating them to apply for jobs in an organization."

Sources of Recruitment

- Internal Sources
- Transfers: Shifting an employee from one job, department, or shift to another without a substantive change in responsibilities

- or status. Can be used for training.
- Promotions: Business enterprises often promote employees from lower jobs to higher positions, increasing responsibilities, facilities, status, and pay.
- Merits of Internal Sources:
 - Employees are motivated.
 - Simplifies selection and placement.
 - Transfers can be a tool for training.
 - Shifts workforce from overstaffed to understaffed departments.
 - Cheaper than external recruitment.
- Limitations of Internal Sources:
 - Reduced scope for fresh talent.
 - Employees may become lethargic if promotions are time-bound.
 - Not suitable for new enterprises.
 - May reduce competition among employees.
 - Frequent transfers can reduce productivity.

External Sources

- Direct Recruitment: A notice on the enterprise's notice-board specifies job details. Job-seekers assemble on a specified date for on-the-spot selection. These workers are often casual or 'badli' workers paid daily wages.
- Casual Callers: Many reputed businesses maintain a database of unsolicited applicants.
- Advertisement: Used in newspapers or professional journals for a wider choice, especially for senior positions.
- Employment Exchange: Government-run exchanges match personnel demand and supply for unskilled and skilled operative jobs.
- Placement Agencies and Management Consultants: Private agencies and professional bodies provide nationwide service in matching personnel demand and supply, particularly for technical and professional areas.
- Campus Recruitment: Colleges and institutes are popular for technical, professional, and managerial jobs.
- Recommendations of Employees: Applicants introduced by present employees, friends, or relatives can be a good source.
- Labour Contractors: Maintain close contacts with laborers and provide unskilled workers at short notice.
- Advertising on Television: A growing source for publicizing vacant posts with detailed job requirements.
- Web Publishing: Internet is a common source of recruitment.
- Merits of External Sources:
 - Qualified Personnel: Access to a wider pool of talent.
 - Wider Choice: More options for selection.
 - Fresh Talent: Brings new ideas and perspectives.
 - Competitive Spirit: Encourages existing employees to perform better.
- Limitations of External Sources:
 - May cause dissatisfaction among existing staff.
 - Often a lengthy and time-consuming process.

Selection

- Definition: The process of identifying and choosing the best person out of a number of prospective candidates for a job.

Process of Selection

- Preliminary Screening: Eliminating unqualified or unfit job seekers based on information supplied in application forms.
- Selection Tests: Mechanisms (paper-and-pencil tests or exercises) to measure characteristics of individuals.
 - Important Tests Used:
 - Intelligence Tests: Measure IQ level.
 - Aptitude Tests: Measure potential for learning new skills.
 - Personality Tests: Provide clues to emotions, reactions, maturity, and value system.
 - Trade Tests: Measure existing skills and proficiency.
 - Interest Tests: Identify patterns of interests or involvement.
- Interview: Formal, in-depth conversation to evaluate suitability.
- Reference and Background Checks: Verifying information and gaining additional insights from references.
- Selection Decision: Final decision made from candidates who passed tests, interviews, and reference checks.
- Medical Examination: Fitness test before job offer.
- Job Offer: Made through an appointment letter, which requires acceptance.
- Contract of Employment: Documents executed by employer and candidate, including attestation form with vital authenticated details.

Training Methods

On-the-Job Methods

- Apprenticeship Programs: Trainee works under a master worker to acquire higher-level skills (e.g., plumbers, iron-workers, electricians).
- Internship Training: Joint program between educational institutions and business firms.

Off-the-Job Methods

- Vestibule Training: Employees learn on equipment they will use, but in a simulated work environment (classroom) away from the actual work floor, using the same materials.

Difference between Training and Development

Feature	Training	Development
Purpose	Increasing knowledge and skills.	Process of learning and growth.
Goal	Enable employee to do the job better.	Enable overall growth of the employee.
Orientation	Job-oriented process.	Career-oriented process.